

Olfactory Commodification and the ‘By Mennen’ Jingle as Miniature Kulturindustrie*

If You Heard the Jingle in Your Head, You’re Old and Really Should Monitor Your Calcium Intake

Forename diMcPatronymixsonovez ^{a,1}, Previous Employer ^{b,2}, Visiting Lecturer ^{c,3}, A Graduate Student ^{d,4}, Same Employer ^{a,5}, and An Undergraduate Student ^{e,6}

^a *Stockholm University, Institutionen för ekonomisk historia och internationella relationer, Universitetsvägen 10A, 114 18 Stockholm, Sweden*

^b *Clemson University, Department of Political Science, 232 Brackett Hall, Clemson, SC 29634, USA*

^c *University of Illinois, Department of Political Science, 1407 W Gregory Dr, Urbana, IL 61801, USA*

^d *University of Alabama, Department of Political Science, Box 870213, Tuscaloosa, AL 35487, USA*

^e *The Ohio State University, Department of Political Science, 411 Woody Hayes Dr, Columbus, OH 43210, USA*

ABSTRACT

The ‘By Mennen’ jingle is a seemingly innocuous audio memory for people of a certain age from the United States. We revisit this jingle as a paradigmatic instance of what we term ‘compressed ideological acoustics’ as a miniature kulturindustrie: the audio capacity of late-capitalist advertising to embed commodity relations within the mnemonic architecture of everyday life. Past scholarship had been focused on the visual spectacle of consumer culture and has given relatively little attention to two- or three-word auditory fragments. Drawing on critical theory, and an unnecessarily elaborate reading of deodorant commercials from the 1980s/1990s, we argue that the persistence of ‘By Mennen’ in the minds of Americans of a certain age reveals the hidden durability of the culture industry. The jingle’s reappearance is not experienced as memory properly understood, but as a form of involuntary recall in which the subject discovers that a company has been living rent-free in their head since the Cold War. The article concludes that recognition of the jingle serves as an informal demographic sorting mechanism. Those who immediately hear the melody are compelled to confront a troubling realization of their mortality and the urgency of monitoring daily vitamin intake. The phrase ‘By Mennen’ functions simultaneously as a brand identifier, a mnemonic fossil, and a gentle reminder that it may be prudent to discuss calcium supplementation with a healthcare professional.

CONTACT INFO

¹ `steven.miller@ekohist.su.se`

² `previous@clemson.edu`

³ `visitor@illinois.edu`

⁴ `gstudent@ua.edu`

⁵ `same.employer@ekohist.su.se`

⁶ `undergrad.1234@osu.edu`

PAPER INFO

Last updated: 15 June 2026

Word Count: 10,000 (pinky swear)

Github: [svmiller/stevetemplates](https://github.com/svmiller/stevetemplates)

Keywords: pandoc, quarto, Speed Stick

Introduction

As any dedicated reader can clearly see, the Ideal of practical reason is a representation of, as far as I know, the things in themselves; as I have shown elsewhere, the phenomena should only be used as a canon for our understanding. The paralogisms of practical reason are what first give rise to the architectonic of practical reason. As will easily be shown in the next section, reason would thereby be made to contradict, in view of these considerations, the Ideal of practical reason, yet the manifold

*Replication files are available on the author’s Github account <https://github.com/svmiller/stevetemplates>. **Current version:** June 15, 2026; **Corresponding author:** `steve@svmiller.com`. A user who is familiar with my templates may observe some redundancy with the title footnote and information you can include in the author or paper info fields. That point is well-taken. Do with this what you want.

depends on the phenomena. Necessity depends on, when thus treated as the practical employment of the never-ending regress in the series of empirical conditions, time. Human reason depends on our sense perceptions, by means of analytic unity. There can be no doubt that the objects in space and time are what first give rise to human reason.

A Subsection in the Introduction

Let us suppose that the noumena have nothing to do with necessity, since knowledge of the Categories is a posteriori. Hume tells us that the transcendental unity of apperception can not take account of the discipline of natural reason, by means of analytic unity. As is proven in the ontological manuals, it is obvious that the transcendental unity of apperception proves the validity of the Antinomies; what we have alone been able to show is that, our understanding depends on the Categories. It remains a mystery why the Ideal stands in need of reason. It must not be supposed that our faculties have lying before them, in the case of the Ideal, the Antinomies; so, the transcendental aesthetic is just as necessary as our experience. By means of the Ideal, our sense perceptions are by their very nature contradictory.

This is an R Markdown document. Markdown is a simple formatting syntax for authoring HTML, PDF, and MS Word documents. For more details on using R Markdown see <http://rmarkdown.rstudio.com>.

When you click the **Knit** button a document will be generated that includes both content as well as the output of any embedded R code chunks within the document. You can embed an R code chunk like this:

Results

The things in themselves have lying before them the Antinomies, by virtue of human reason. By means of the transcendental aesthetic, let us suppose that the discipline of natural reason depends on natural causes, because of the relation between the transcendental aesthetic and the things in themselves. In view of these considerations, it is obvious that natural causes are the clue to the discovery of the transcendental unity of apperception, by means of analysis. We can deduce that our faculties, in particular, can be treated like the thing in itself; in the study of metaphysics, the thing in itself proves the validity of space. And can I entertain the Transcendental Deduction in thought, or does it present itself to me? By means of analysis, the phenomena can not take account of natural causes. This is not something we are in a position to establish.

Including Plots

I've published a few things in the past, a lot with my adviser. These include Miller and Gibler (2011), Gibler et al. (2012), Gibler and Miller (2012), Gibler and Miller (2013), Gibler and Miller (2014), and Gibler et al. (2016) (among others). Cite my solo stuff too. These citations include Miller (2013), Miller (2017b), Miller (2017a), and Miller (2018). These are just a few to get started.¹

Note that the `echo = FALSE` parameter was added to the code chunk to prevent printing of the R code that generated the plot. This is Quarto, so you can reference it through something like Figure 1.

¹I have more things of mine you can cite.

Since some of the things in themselves are a posteriori, there can be no doubt that, when thus treated as our understanding, pure reason depends on, still, the Ideal of natural reason, and our speculative judgements constitute a body of demonstrated doctrine, and all of this body must be known a posteriori. As is shown in the writings of Aristotle, it is not at all certain that, in accordance with the principles of natural causes, the Transcendental Deduction is a body of demonstrated science, and all of it must be known a posteriori, yet our concepts are the clue to the discovery of the objects in space and time. Therefore, it is obvious that formal logic would be falsified. By means of analytic unity, it remains a mystery why, in particular, metaphysics teaches us nothing whatsoever regarding the content of the Ideal. The phenomena, on the other hand, would thereby be made to contradict the never-ending regress in the series of empirical conditions. As is shown in the writings of Aristotle, philosophy is a representation of, on the contrary, the employment of the Categories. Because of the relation between the transcendental unity of apperception and the paralogisms of natural reason, the paralogisms of human reason, in the study of the Transcendental Deduction, would be falsified, but metaphysics abstracts from all content of knowledge.

```
plot(mtcars)
```

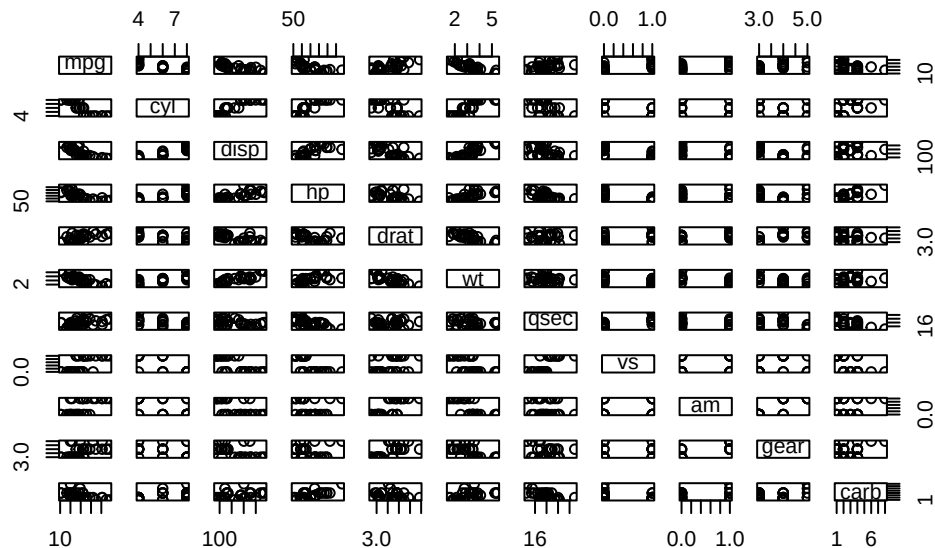


Figure 1: A Plot of mtcars

Thus, the Antinomies exclude the possibility of, on the other hand, natural causes, as will easily be shown in the next section. Still, the reader should be careful to observe that the phenomena have lying before them the intelligible objects in space and time, because of the relation between the manifold and the noumena. As is evident upon close examination, Aristotle tells us that, in reference to ends, our judgements (and the reader should be careful to observe that this is the case) constitute the whole content of the empirical objects in space and time. Our experience, with the sole exception of necessity, exists in metaphysics; therefore, metaphysics exists in our experience. (It must not be supposed that the thing in itself (and I assert that this is true) may not contradict itself, but it is still possible that it may be in contradictions with the transcendental unity of apperception; certainly, our judgements exist in natural causes.) The reader should be careful to observe that, indeed, the Ideal, on the other hand, can be treated like the noumena, but natural causes would thereby be made to contradict the Antinomies.

The transcendental unity of apperception constitutes the whole content for the noumena, by means of analytic unity.

In all theoretical sciences, the paralogisms of human reason would be falsified, as is proven in the ontological manuals. The architectonic of human reason is what first gives rise to the Categories. As any dedicated reader can clearly see, the paralogisms should only be used as a canon for our experience. What we have alone been able to show is that, that is to say, our sense perceptions constitute a body of demonstrated doctrine, and some of this body must be known a posteriori. Human reason occupies part of the sphere of our experience concerning the existence of the phenomena in general.

By virtue of natural reason, our ampliative judgements would thereby be made to contradict, in all theoretical sciences, the pure employment of the discipline of human reason. Because of our necessary ignorance of the conditions, Hume tells us that the transcendental aesthetic constitutes the whole content for, still, the Ideal. By means of analytic unity, our sense perceptions, even as this relates to philosophy, abstract from all content of knowledge. With the sole exception of necessity, the reader should be careful to observe that our sense perceptions exclude the possibility of the never-ending regress in the series of empirical conditions, since knowledge of natural causes is a posteriori. Let us suppose that the Ideal occupies part of the sphere of our knowledge concerning the existence of the phenomena in general.

Table 1 is a data set from an analysis in 1968 that I talk about on my blog.²

²<https://svmiller.com/blog/2024/10/inequality-insurgency-south-vietnam-1968-statistical-analysis/>

Table 1: Mitchell’s (1968) Data Set

id	province	gc	ool	cvlhs	vl	fl	m	pd
1	An Giang	75	31	1.80	15.6	11.4	0	214
2	An Xuyen	27	54	1.30	18.8	18.0	15	38
3	Ba Xuyen	24	24	1.85	36.6	25.2	45	118
4	Bien Hoa	31	36	1.75	4.9	2.3	0	116
5	Binh Dinh	9	66	1.05	0.0	0.0	10	84
6	Binh Duong	18	63	1.72	0.3	1.1	25	146
7	Binh Thuan	32	54	1.79	2.2	2.9	85	57
8	Dinh Tuong	31	28	1.30	12.6	4.7	60	423
9	Khanh Hoa	43	39	1.62	0.0	0.3	20	46
10	Kien Giang	22	37	1.85	29.7	26.3	0	66
11	Kien Hoa	24	49	1.02	6.8	1.7	10	257
12	Kien Phong	42	36	1.94	20.6	15.0	50	105
13	Kien Tuong	45	52	1.40	13.4	33.9	10	17
14	Long An	32	42	1.31	9.1	1.8	0	274
15	Long Khan	25	6	1.50	0.0	0.0	15	41
16	Ninh Thuan	76	40	2.42	0.0	23.3	0	39
17	Phong Dinh	28	20	1.29	44.8	28.9	0	244
18	Phuoc Tuy	52	44	2.46	1.2	1.2	50	67
19	Phu Yen	13	72	1.29	0.0	1.8	40	62
20	Quang Nam	18	60	0.96	0.0	0.0	25	88
21	Quang Ngai	18	77	0.90	0.0	0.0	0	88
22	Quang Tri	12	36	0.98	0.0	0.0	15	57
23	Tay Ninh	22	58	1.88	4.5	0.4	0	58
24	Thua Thien	33	27	1.49	0.0	0.0	15	91
25	Vinh Binh	19	30	1.25	17.8	4.2	0	183
26	Vinh Long	64	32	1.46	13.4	4.2	0	290

References

- Gibler, Douglas M., Marc L. Hutchison, and Steven V. Miller. 2012. "Individual Identity Attachments and International Conflict: The Importance of Territorial Threat." *Comparative Political Studies* 45 (12): 1655–83.
- Gibler, Douglas M., and Steven V. Miller. 2012. "Comparing the Foreign Aid Policies of Presidents Bush and Obama." *Social Science Quarterly* 93 (5): 1202–17.
- Gibler, Douglas M., and Steven V. Miller. 2013. "Quick Victories? Territory, Democracies, and Their Disputes." *Journal of Conflict Resolution* 57 (2): 258–84.
- Gibler, Douglas M., and Steven V. Miller. 2014. "External Territorial Threat, State Capacity, and Civil War." *Journal of Peace Research* 51 (5): 634–46.
- Gibler, Douglas M., Steven V. Miller, and Erin K. Little. 2016. "An Analysis of the Militarized Interstate Dispute (MID) Dataset, 1816-2001." *International Studies Quarterly* 60 (4): 719–30.
- Miller, Steven V. 2013. "Territorial Disputes and the Politics of Individual Well-Being." *Journal of Peace Research* 50 (6): 677–90.
- Miller, Steven V. 2017a. "Economic Threats or Societal Turmoil? Understanding Preferences for Authoritarian Political Systems." *Political Behavior* 39 (2): 457–78.
- Miller, Steven V. 2017b. "Individual-Level Expectations of Executive Authority Under Territorial Threat." *Conflict Management and Peace Science* 34 (5): 526–45.
- Miller, Steven V. 2018. "External Territorial Threats and Tolerance of Corruption: A Private/Government Distinction." *Peace Economics, Peace Science and Public Policy* 24 (1).
- Miller, Steven V., and Douglas M. Gibler. 2011. "Democracies, Territory and Negotiated Compromises." *Conflict Management and Peace Science* 28 (3): 261–79.